



St. Mary's Parish, Clonguish, Newtownforbes, Co. Longford.

Tel: 043-3346465 (Longford) / 043-3346805 (Newtownforbes)

Website www.clonguishparish.ie Email: stmelscathedral@gmail.com Webcam: churchtv.ie/newtownforbes

Mass times: Sunday: 7pm Vigil & 10.30am. Monday & Friday: 7pm

Fr James Mac Kiernan, Fr Michael McGrath, Fr Tony Gilhooly, Fr Francis Onugha, Fr Jude Bistu

Parish Newsletter

Mass Intentions - 26th Week in Ordinary Time

World Day for Migrants and Refugees

Saturday 26th @ 7pm: Nicola Murphy & DFM

Sunday 27th @ 10.30am: No Intention

Monday 28th @ 7pm: No Intention

Friday 2nd Oct @ 7pm: Leah Sheridan

Mass Intentions - 27th Week in Ordinary Time

Saturday 3rd Oct @ 7pm: No Intention

Sunday 4th Oct @ 10.30am: Florrie Geelan - 1st Anniv

OFFERTORY COLLECTION: We thank you most sincerely for your contributions to the Collection last weekend which amounted to €1,050.

PARISH PASTORAL COUNCIL Meeting will take place on Monday evening, **28th September** at 7.45pm.

FIRST FRIDAY calls will take place on **Thursday**. Please contact the Parish Office, Longford 04333 46465 before Wednesday if you would like a priest to call with Holy Communion.

CONFESSIONS will be heard in St Mel's Cathedral on **Thursday 1st October** - 10.30-11.30am and 7.00-7.30pm.

BAPTISM MEETING: All those with a child for Baptism in the coming months are advised that the next Baptism Enrolment Meeting will take place on Friday evening, **2nd October** at **8pm** in the Octagonal Room, **St Mel's Cathedral**.

27th September 2026

PARISH FUNERAL MINISTRY training commences on **Wednesday 30th September** for 3 consecutive Wednesday nights in the Family Centre, St Mel's Road, Longford N39 E927- tea/coffee @ 7pm, workshop @ 7.30pm.

DEPAUL LONGFORD HOMELESS SERVICE will hold their Annual Churchgate Collection **3rd/4th October**. All donations gratefully appreciated. Thank you for your support.

ST MARY'S CHURCH CHOIR welcomes new members. Rehearsals take place Tuesdays 7.30-9pm. No previous choir experience necessary; music and learning tracks provided. Contact Margaret Brennan 087 753 0247/smccsings@gmail.com.

LONGFORD ALZHEIMER CAFÉ hold their next monthly meeting on **Wednesday 30th September @ 7pm** in their office on Earl Street, Longford.

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION takes place in St Mary's Church every **Wednesday** from 7pm-8pm

BLESSING OF FAMILY PETS You are invited to bring along your family pets for a special blessing on **Sunday 4th October at 3pm** in the Portico of the Cathedral. Please pass on this invitation to your neighbours, friends and family. We look forward to seeing all creatures - great and small - and ask that owners are careful to keep their pets and others safe and secure on the day.

OFFICE HOURS: Monday & Wednesday - Parochial House - 9am to 12noon.

Next Weekend
7pm
10.30am

Readers:
Ann McCann
Laura Hussey

Eucharistic Ministers:
Martin Ross
Elizabeth Moore

On-line banking: IBAN: IE34 AIBK 9321 4026 9364 22
(BIC AIBKIE2D). Parish of Clonguish A/c AIB Longford

If you need the assistance of a priest or wish to make a booking for Baptism or Wedding please contact: The Presbytery, St Mel's, Longford

ST. MARY'S CHURCH, BOHERQUILL

email: mcdcoath@gmail.com

FR. PIERRE MOBILE: 087 6960542



WEEKDAY MASSES

Tuesday

Boherquill – 9.30 am

Wednesday

Rathowen – 9.30am

Thursday

Rathowen – 9.30am. Adoration 10-10.30am

Friday

Boherquill – 8pm. Adoration 7 – 8pm.

WEEKEND MASSES 26th/27th

Sat 26th: No intention

Sun 27th: Josephine McNamara M/M. Patarica Moran
Ann Grimes.

WEEKEND MASSES 3rd/4th

Sat 3rd: No intention

Sun 4th: Marcella Farrell, Fairyhall. Ambrose/ Rosemarie
MaGuire

NEWS HEADLINES

A: Pope Leo in France will find a secular country at odds with Catholic teaching on life. **B:** Urgent need to address dangers: American bishops meet AI representatives. **C:** New convert and author says French Catholics have now learnt from Islam to be proud of their faith. **D:** Catholic university works to preserve Lebanon's Christian past, for the future. **E:** 600,000 sign up for Pope Leo's Paris mass, as organisers expand route. **F:** UK bill proposes to lift historic restrictions on Catholic and Jewish Prime Ministers. **G:** 800 years after St Francis death, new digital project preserves his basilica for years to come. **H:** Vatican children's hospital: No one in Europe, No 4 in the world according to new ranking. **I:** A Muslim father tried to burn his daughters alive for becoming Christians. **J:** Catholic church in Germany contributes €595 million in international aid in 2025.

LEGION OF MARY.

The annual Legion of Mary pilgrimage to Knock takes this weekend, Sunday 27th. Devotion begins with the anointing of the sick at 2.30pm, followed by mass and the rosary procession at 3pm. A bus will leave Sunday morning from the Bay Horse Granard at 8am and the Parkhouse Edgeworthstown at 8.15am. To reserve a seat call Kitty on 086-0405621 or Peter 087-6613510.

SAINTLY WISDOM 'HOPE'

"Hope always draws the soul from the beauty that is seen to what is beyond, always kindles the desire for the hidden through what is perceived". .. St Gregory of Nyssa.

"The most hopeful people in the world are the young and the drunk: the first because they have little experiences of failure, and the second because they have succeeded in drowning theirs"..... St Thomas Aquinas

Hide yourself in Jesus crucified, and hope for nothing except that all men be thoroughly converted to his will. That all may be truly free"..... St Paul of the cross.

REST IN PEACE: The prayers of the church are asked for the repose of the soul of Diana Reilly (née Riggs) England and Rathowen, Daughter of Frank and Eithna Riggs, who died during the week. May she rest in peace.

BLESSING OF THE GRAVES 2027.

Russagh and Rathaspic Sat June 12th, (mass in Russagh)

Streete, Coolamber, Boherquill, Sat June 26th.

OFFERTORY COLLECTION 19th/20th Sept

A LITTLE THEOLOGY 'AGNOSTISM'

Agnosticism, defined as "the belief that nothing can be known about the existence of God or the supernatural". The church views this view as an error that limits human reason's capacity to know God through both natural logic and divine revelation. According to the Catechism of the Catholic Church agnosticism can take many forms firstly some agnostics make no judgement about God, declaring it is impossible to prove, affirm, or deny. Secondly, others accept a vague transcendent being, entirely hidden and incapable of being known or of revealing itself, lastly agnosticism that stems from an indifference, a sluggish conscience, or an active avoidance of life's ultimate question's. The church maintains that human reason can know God with certainty through creation, divine revelation & above all in Jesus Christ. We may experience doubt while in the pew, but this is not the same as agnosticism.

MEDJUGORJE PILGRIMAGE.

The annual pilgrimage to Medjugorje will take place from the 14th to the 21st of October, cost of the pilgrimage is €915, which includes flights from Knock airport, accommodation, breakfast and dinner taxes and transfers. The price is based on Per Person sharing Fr's PJ Huges and Jorom will accompany the group as spiritual directors. For more information or to reserve a place you can call Jerry on 087-4309096.

MAGNIFICA HUMANITAS.

One topic that seems to be becoming more and more of a matter of concern for all of humanity is the rapid development of AI, a tool which will be of immense benefit to humanity, but one that requires enlightened controls and a clear set of goals that ensure that it will be an instrument of peace and universal benefit. Pope Leo has written an encyclical letter entitled 'Magnifica humanitas' meaning the magnificent human, which set the person at the center of any development, the encyclical has been warmly received by many involved in AI research, and seen as a road map for ongoing progress. With just 100 pages it is accessible to everyone who is concerned and seeks guidance. Available from bookstation Ireland or from the Vatican website www.vatican.va.

